

Example 2:

Let's say you wait a little longer to invest and you start at age 35 with a goal to retire 30 years later at age 65. You start investing \$5,000 a year (or \$416.67 a month) and have the same average rate of return of 6%. After 30 years, your investment would be worth **\$419,008.39** versus **\$151,975.26 (0.09%)** or **\$202,842.02 (2%)** if you just put your money in a savings account.

This table illustrates what your annual and total contributions could be as well as what the growth of your money could be over that 30-year time period as a result of compounding.

Age	Total Contributions	Rate of Return (6%)	Total
35	\$5,000	\$300	\$5,300.00
36	\$10,000	\$918	\$10,918.00
37	\$15,000	\$1,873.08	\$16,873.08
38	\$20,000	\$3,185.46	\$23,185.46
39	\$25,000	\$4,876.59	\$29,876.59
40	\$30,000	\$6,969.19	\$36,969.19
41	\$35,000	\$9,487.34	\$44,487.34
42	\$40,000	\$12,456.58	\$52,456.58
43	\$45,000	\$15,903.97	\$60,903.97
44	\$50,000	\$19,858.21	\$69,858.21
45	\$55,000	\$24,349.71	\$79,349.71
46	\$60,000	\$29,410.69	\$89,410.69
47	\$65,000	\$35,075.33	\$100,075.33
48	\$70,000	\$41,379.85	\$111,379.85
49	\$75,000	\$48,362.64	\$123,362.64
50	\$80,000	\$56,064.40	\$136,064.40
51	\$85,000	\$64,528.26	\$149,528.26